

Under Operation Enhance, the United States supplied South Vietnam with 63 working trucks—and 1,350 broken ones—along with weapons and other vehicles.



The deal is sealed

Henry Kissinger shakes hands with Le Duc Tho on January 23, 1973, to conclude their negotiations. This final, four-hour meeting was held in the Peninsula Hotel on Avenue Kleber in Paris; previous talks had taken place in private apartments and villas.

Final drafts

The popular history of these last months of talks is that Kissinger and Le Duc Tho came to a draft accord, to which South Vietnam demanded numerous changes that Hanoi would reject. In this version of events, North Vietnam meekly accepted Thieu's demands after the Christmas Bombing, and the Paris agreement was based on the revised formula. However, a comparison of the draft agreement of October 1972 and the one signed in January 1973 tells a different story. The most significant change was that the national council would not be an "administrative structure," which minimized the possibility of it emerging as a coalition government. Le Duc Tho agreed to that on December 8—before the Christmas